Sam Sharman

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EMPLOYMENT

INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY OF JAPAN
Assistant Professor of Political Science, Graduate School of International Relations
(September 2026–Present)

EDUCATION

TEXAS A&M UNIVERSITY
Ph.D. in Political Science, 2026
Dissertation: Political Succession and International Political Economy
Committee: José Antonio Cheibub (chair), Quan Li (co-chair), Scott J. Cook, and David Bearce

GEORGIA STATE UNIVERSITY
M.A. in Political Science, 2020
B.A. in Political Science, 2019

PUBLICATIONS

Kockaya, Leon, Spencer Goidel, and Sam Sharman. "Surveil Thy Neighbor: Priming Policy Preferences and Support for State Surveillance." Forthcoming in *Journal of Politics*. https://doi.org/10.1086/744221.

Sharman, Sam. 2024. "Labor Mobility and Semi-Presidentialism." *Electoral Studies* 88 (April): 102772.

WORKING PAPERS

"Succession, Stability, and Sovereign Bonds in Sub-Saharan Africa." Revise & resubmit at *Comparative Political Studies*.

"Succession from Strength: Coups and Autocratic Succession Rules in Sub-Saharan Africa." Under Review.

"The Conditional Importance of the Rule of Law for Foreign Direct Investment in Autocracies" (with Hongbi Choi). Under Review.

"The Mortality Dividend: Leader Deaths and Market Reactions" (with Leon Kockaya).

SELECTED WORKS IN PROGRESS

Constitutions, Coups, and Credit: The Domestic and International Politics of Autocratic Succession in Africa (book project).

"Selective Electoral Manipulation: Security, Information, and Legitimacy in Autocratic Elections."

"Beyond Authoritarian Populism: Testing Nativism As the Primary Driver of Contemporary Politics" (with Clifford Young, Kirby Goidel, and Julia Reyes).

"Emotions and Costless Credible Signaling" (with Erik Chi and Nathan McCoslin).

"Observing Costly Signaling" (with Nicholas Ray).

"Secrecy Appeals and Public Support for Conflict Escalation" (with Matthew J. Conklin and Eddy S. F. Yeung).

"Whataboutism and Public Support for Foreign Interference" (with Matthew J. Conklin and Eddy S. F. Yeung).

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

American Association of Public Opinion Researchers (AAPOR): 2026

American Political Science Association (APSA): 2024

Australian Society for Quantitative Political Science (ASQPS): 2026

International Political Economy Society (IPES): 2023, 2025 (Poster)

Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA): 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026

Southern Political Science Association (SPSA): 2022 (Virtual Summer), 2024

INVITED TALKS

Louisiana State University (October 2025)

International University of Japan (September 2025)

TEACHING

International University of Japan

- African Politics (graduate) (Fall 2026)
- Comparative Political Economy (graduate) (Winter 2027)
- Political Analysis (graduate) (Spring 2027)

Texas A&M University

Instructor of Record
- INTA 606: International Politics in Theory and Practice (graduate) (Fall 2025)
- POLS 424: Comparative Governmental Institutions (Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Spring 2026)
- POLS 318: Theories of International Relations (Fall 2025)

Teaching Assistant
- POLS 606: Causal Inference (graduate) (Fall 2023, Hannah Simpson)
- POLS 603: Quantitative Political Analysis II (graduate) (Spring 2023, Scott J. Cook)
- POLS 602: Quantitative Political Analysis I (graduate) (Fall 2022, Paul Kellstedt)
- POLS 309: Polimetrics (Fall 2021, Alicia Cooperman; Spring 2022, Casey Crisman-Cox)
- POLS 209: Introduction to Political Science Research (Fall 2020, Carlo Horz; Spring 2024, Ali Kagalwala)
- POLS 200: Foundations of Political Science (Spring 2021, José Antonio Cheibub)

GRANTS

Institute for Humane Studies, Expense Support Grant, $5,000, *Emotions and Costless Credible Signaling* (2026)

Texas A&M University, internal graduate student research support grant, $1,750, *Surveil Thy Neighbor* with Leon Kockaya (2024)

DEPARTMENT SERVICE

Texas A&M University

President of the Political Science Graduate Student Association, 2023–2024
Graduate Student Mentor, 2023–2025

REVIEWER SERVICE

Comparative Political Studies
Electoral Studies
Government & Opposition
Journal of Politics
Social Science Quarterly

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

American Political Science Association
International Political Economy Society
International Studies Association
Midwest Political Science Association
Southern Political Science Association